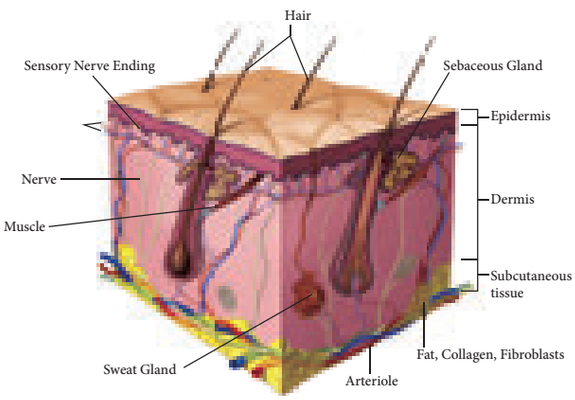
Skin

The human skin is the outer covering of the body and is the largest organ of the integumentary system. The main functions are protection, regulation and sensation.



Cross-section of all skin layers.

The skin has the following layers from exterior to the inner layer.

- The epidermis
- The dermis
- The hypodermis (subcutaneous layer)

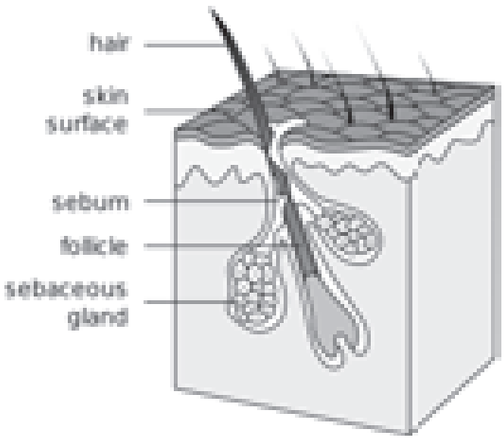
The epidermis is a vascular (without blood vessels); the skin contains keratin which protects and prevents the skin from becoming water logged.

The dermis, the middle layer of the skin, contains blood vessels, gives the skin its elasticity to stretch.

The hypodermis, the subcutaneous layer, stores fat that are ready for use when energy is needed. This layer of skin fat also maintains body temperature by serving as an insulator.

Hair

Hair keeps the body warm. Hair covers the majority of the body surface; thick hair is found on the head and face and fine hair is found on other parts of the body such as the pubic area. Hair has a follicle below the skin, and a shaft above the skin. Hair contains keratin.



Schematic view of hair follicle and sebaceous gland

DO YOU KNOW?

Eye lashes protect the eyes from foreign debris getting into the eye.

Sebaceous Glands

Sebaceous glands are exocrine glands. It lubricate and moisturize the skin with an oily secretion which is called as sebum and maintains thermoregulation.

DO YOU KNOW?

There are no sebaceous glands in the palms and sole of the feet.

Nail

The finger and toe nails are made of keratin. Nails protect the tips of our fingers and toes from injury.

Three parts of the nail are:

- Nail bed
- Nail matrix
- Nail plate.



Nail

Sweat Glands

Sweat glands are exocrine and apocrine glands that secretes sweat to the surface of

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